

① INDIAN FOREIGN POLICY - DETERMINANTS, INSTITUTIONS, CONTINUITY & CHANGE

+ Swami Vivekananda - world as a gymnasium where nations come to make themselves strong

* Strategic Culture - 1st given by Jack Snyder,

- culture - values, beliefs, etc developed, retained & passed to generations,

likewise strat. culture is set of state behaviour in matters considered as strategic

- social constructivist

- Kanti Bajpai - 2 parts of str. cul.

- sources - his, politics, geo, etc

→ central strategic paradigm
→ grand strategy

Q. India has strategic culture?

- debated

+ George Tanham - "lacked formal and systematic strategic planning" and thus lacks str. culture;

• Indian strategic thought : an interpretative essay & he argued Indian values, cul diversity, recent his legacy & non align. stymied str. thought proliferation.

- criticised as being "rudimentary & impulsive" than objective definition & understanding

+ India has a strategic culture -

- Kautilya's arthashastra - proactive measures of a pragmatic ruler

- Henry Kissinger 'World Order' - Kautilya shows how to protect state interests while subverting & conquering neighbours

- S Jaishankar 'The Indian Way' - Mahabharata as most distilled form of str. culture, chapter dealing with "Krishna's choice" shows "strategic culture of using India's power". - reference of Mahabharata to show India's str. cul. and vivid distillation of India's statecraft. Mahabharata - tale of ethics and power

- Morris Jones call him ethnocentric

- Tanham view is criticised as - w. perspective of security that undermines the value of mil strength but also does not recognise the importance of diplomatic and peaceful efforts to address security

DETERMINANTS - continuity & change is reflected due to the determinants, vary across space & time

Domestic politics - no country's FP can be immune from the "dynamics within"

- nowadays we have consensus based govt → degree of acceptability is depended on pol system
- eg - C.R.M - one of factors for adopt NAM as FP was to gain domestic consensus as India had both left & right
- Indo-US Nuclear Treaty 2008 - coalition pressures
- vote against SL in UNHRC - Test agreement
- informal blockade on Nepal - Middle east policy

- organisation and structure of govt also impacts FP, nature of leg. & executive

- continuity has been due to nature of govt making in India

eg - unity in diversity model = national consensus across pol differences - NAM

- Nehru era - parl asserted the policy vis a vis dispute - China & Goa 1950s

- 2003 - approach to Iraq - parl wanted govt to become party in deploying US actions against Iraq

- regional influence - SL, Nepal, ~~IND~~ Pak

- public opinion through media - Hijack of 1999

II) Geography - Napoleon - "any country's FP is determined by its geo".

- size and location of India has significance
- most permanent & stable factor, needs & capability to fulfill people's aspirations

eg - US isolationist policy due to geo location

- English channel in der of Britain as naval and imperial power

- due
- India's location - geopol and geostrategic significance
 - 3 sides - ocean ["Security enhanced in Ind ocean"
 - located at centre of Middle east, SE Asia and far east → hence relations with Iraq, Russia
 - Vajpayee - one can change friends, not neighbours
 - look east & act east - strategic partnerships w/ ASEAN

- 3 challenges to FP due to location -
- S Asia was single entity but partition of subcont. and partition created unsettled borders
eg - Pak, China, Nepal, SL
- unfriendly neighbours that limits reach & influence
- asymmetry of power in region → trust deficit

→ Happyman Jacob - continental sphere since 1947 - not yielded huge results, time to change geo and strategic approach to maritime sphere

III) Leadership - kabhi of state = leader

- Thucydides = nature of ind leaders & styles
- Machiavelli = Prince - book for leaders
- Rosenau = a leader's beliefs about nature of intl arena and goals.

- national leaders = 2 level game < domestic intl
↳ motivated by 2 goals - pol power a/c Neack - maintain policy coalitions

- Harsh V Pant & Indian FP: Modi Era' book - Modi has become India's ambassador selling brand India, inviting investment, soft power strategically used, focus on diaspora

- eg - Reagan and Wilson - diff approach towards USSR
- I. Gandhi - Bangladesh, non accession to NPT - pragmatic and sensitivity
- A.B. Vajpayee - US, Pak

- CRM - Modi doctrine - Central to contribution of conduct of external relations taking India as leading power in intl system. India is moving from reactive to proactive in intl outcomes
- Restrictions - govt & social structures, two level game

IV) History and culture - ^{human part of env' that provides diff ways of looking at world}

- legacy of ancient civilisation and culture and phil. tradition
- elements of tolerance, middle way (ati sarvatra varjayet), universal peace & brotherhood
eg - Nehru policy inspired by Buddhism & Ashoka
Modi - Ch. Maurya & Kautilya
- Rosenau - cul factors is not limited to impact of societal unity upon formulation & implementation of for policy, equally imp are processes through which contents of "shared norms & practices" of society
- culture
 - eg - Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam - G20
 - non violence - A/C A Appadorai - in NFU, champion of Global South, peaceful nuclear use
 - pluralism & tolerance - humanitarian interventions secure diaspora interest
 - panchsheel
 - PM Modi - 'era not of war' - Buddha & Gandhi non violence
 - spiritual power - Gandhi, Aurobindo, Tagore - cold war non alignment
 - liberal edu - constitution & institution - Art 51
eg - UN led reforms
- history - constructive influence on policy
- eg - Brubaker - A Appadorai - 2 fold impact -
1) stimulus to INM and 2) support to people around the world, against any racial discrimination

- Richard M Fontana - 'Anti colonialism as Basic India's responses to problems of intl concerns are determined by fact that it divide the world into pro colonial and anti colonial blocs
- K S Murthy - ancient Hindu FP was one of isolationism
- India's role as big brother in S Asia - Br legacy
Border tensions
- Kautilya - use of pragmatism - Nehru & I Gandhi in case of Goa and Bangladesh

v) social structure -

- state divided on racial/rel./regional lines struggle more than homogenous society
- eg - Britain's unity under Churchill in WW2 = social solidarity let them suffer hardships
- Nehru "FP is extension of dom. policy"
- soft power - diaspora
muslim connect - extended neighbourhood
- ethnicity similarities with S Asia create issues
- Tahiriz Ahmad "we should not exaggerate dom. requirements of pro Arab policy, it was energy than ethnicity that shaped the W Asia policy"
- support to development over trade -
eg - Doha round
- patriarchal in nature.

CONTINUITY AND CHANGE

The Indian policy community is divided on where the foreign policy is headed. Is there a departure from past or continuity of past. However, there are both, elements of change & cont.

A/C to Jaisankar, Indian FP has evolved in 6 phases.

→ 1946-62 - 1st phase - optimistic non alignment

- bipolar world order → "India resisted constraining choices and dilution of sovereignty" as it rebuilt economy and consolidated integrity,
- quest for decolonised equitable world order,
- energetic diplomacy from Korea & Vietnam to Suez and Hungary;
- 1962 conflict brought this to end

→ 1962-71 - 2nd phase - "realism and recovery" -

- pragmatic choices based on security and pol challenges despite constrained resources
- looked for national security

eg - Defence agreement w/ USA - 1964

- Kashmir pressures mounted

- limited cooperation b/w US & USSR

- S Asia - region of convergence

India faced both superpowers together
eg - Tashkent 1965

→ 1971-91 - 3rd phase -

① "greater Indian regional assertion"

- decisive dismantlement of Ind-Pak equivalence

Bangladesh - 1971, misadventure in SL

- adoption of more pro Soviet positions
- US-China-Pak axis threatened India's prospects
- collapse of USSR led India to look for domestic & FP principles

- 1991-2001 - 4th phase - safeguarding str. autonomy
- dissolution of USSR and emergence of unipolar world
 - focus shifted to safeguard strategic autonomy
 - opened more economically to world - NEP
 - Look east, adjustment on Israel issue, engaged US more intensively; yet while protecting its critical areas
 - securing nuclear weapon option and trade negotiations & strategic autonomy.
 - Pak's adventurism in Kargil (1999)
 - US more focused on Asian developments and consequences of Islamic fundamentalism

- 2001-2014 - 5th phase - India as balancing power
- more competitive env - new windows of opportunity
 - US ~~questions~~ unipolarity was questioned
 - India to work w/ diff powers on diff issues
 - "balancing power" role
 - common cause with China on cc & trade, Russia, BRICS as major forum

- 2014 - 6th phase - "energetic engagement"
- more energetic diplomacy,
 - world of convergences and issue based arrangements →
 - growth of sense of own capabilities
eg - Negotiations @ Paris on cc,
inv. in South

→ R. Tagore - you cannot cross the sea merely by standing and staring at water.
India will require a beginning, a thinking that keeps up with times.

- S Jaishankar highlights shifts in Modi era -
- i) partnerships with like minded countries
 - ii) manage great power relationships - regional & global footprints
 - iii) pragmatic decisions on risk-benefit calculation
 - iv) unpredictability to enhance value
 - v) instrumentality of military power
 - vi) defense policies
 - vii) business & inv. central to diplomacy
 - viii) stronger drive in implementation
 - ix) soft power strategic use
 - x) diaspora card

→ Foreign policy does not change in sharp breaks from past, but at a gradual pace.

→ US -

- growing convergence on security & diplomatic architecture of Asia Pacific = (continuity)
- Obama in 2015 "We affirm the importance of safeguarding maritime security and ensuring FON and over flights throughout region, esp S China sea"
- direct references to S China sea in Indo-US joint statement 2014

→ China -

- PM Modi @ Raisina dialogue 2017 - "both our countries show sensitivity and respect for each other's core concerns and interests"
- new normal - India deals with China with candour and confidence, engage, compete and cooperate simultaneously
- simultaneous rise of China & India as major world economies is a new factor. India sometimes has to concede to China in pragmatic side stepping
eg - HQ. of BRICS and AIIB

- Pakistan
 - relations has swung from dialogue to crisis
 - with strategic balance shifting in India's favour, Pak. has engaged in sub-conventional and asymmetric warfare.
 - For India, terrorism remains the core issue.
 - eg - LeT chief Hafiz Saeed, Pathankot attacks linked to JeM chief, LeT for Mumbai attacks

- Bangladesh -
 - resolution of boundary dispute with Bangladesh

- Asia Pacific
 - strong Ind ocean policy to combat maritime terrorism,
 - initiatives such as SAGAR, IFSMC

- Economic realm -

Diplomacy of Development -

- ↳ Enlisting foreign partners for India's dev has been core since 1947, further enhanced under Modi era

- ↳ goal of 8.5% eco growth
- ↳ share of manufacturing - 17 to 25%.
- ↳ partners of inv - UK, UAE, Japan, France, Germany

- Culture has come at centre of FP and India's diplomatic outreach
- ↳ counter narrative to west centric view of history and inter state relations
- ↳ eg - Yoga, promotion of Nalanda as an int'l partnership

- ⇒ change
- globally - leading world role. than mere balancing ^{one,}
realisation of pursuit to become great power -
set agenda on burning intl issues of day. than
merely shaping outcomes. India is prepared to
lead negotiation of global covenants - eg G20
 - willingness to shoulder responsibility of global
commons
eg - humanitarian operations, UNPK, maritime & c.c
 - the evolution of Look east to act east is shift
from conception to outcomes.
 - Afghanistan - supply of M1 25 ground attackers
to combat terrorism,
 - Israel re-opened embassies

The fact that India's foreign and security policies are enablers in transformation of India is now well understood among thinking Indians. In that sense, by getting tied to domestic policy, that receives greater public attention, foreign policy has woven itself into people's consciousness. India is being recast

Foreign policy

S Jaishankar - India's foreign policy aims to uphold "greater fairness and justice".

He adds that foreign policy has changed from its beginning to reflect a lot of deep socio-economic concerns we have in India. Just like there are transformations within country, India seeks to transform the world outside.

→ China -

Shiv Shankar Menon "India and Asian Geopolitics" -

Challenges - border (spring of 2020), Chinese military activity, IOR, Gwadar port, insurgent groups in NE.

Two countries need to find a paradigm for relation or new framework within which to manage or settle issues and take relations forward.
The situation calls for a "fundamental reset" of India - China relations

"Choices: Inside the making of foreign policy" - biggest challenge was that world env became less supportive of efforts to transform India.
Rise of US-China rivalry, opening new arenas in India-US relations, challenges at border.
China has emerged as greatest strategic challenge but also greatest trading partner.

→ J N Dixit - "for. policy of a country is a statement for what it stands for and role that it takes upon itself and projects to world at large"

- Gaps in casting foreign policy -
- understanding of every situation on global platform is at 3 diff levels -
 - real situation
 - official version
 - rosy picture

Challenges

- China
- Russian ties - when 1962 war Russia called one as brother, other as friend,
LAC issue least interested by Russia
- UNSC, NSG

- S Jaishankar - India aspires to be "leading power, than just balancing power"
- Happyman Jacob - India will not be toast of western world until it is able to get back on its feet
- Harsh V Pant - India must make most of its geopolitical sweet spot.
 - Michael Patra - India's emerging role as a "second most imp driver of eco growth after China"
- Happyman Jacob - contemp. foreign policy is textual explanation of treading faultlines of world politics
 - S Jaishankar - "Indian Way" - advancing nat. interests by identifying and exploiting opportunities created by global contradictions.

INDIA'S NEUTRALITY vs. GLOBAL LEADER

→ Too neutral?

- Happyman Jacob - not a satellite state, nor camp follower. ; itself a pole

→ India as a pole power -

On Intl front, India is often referred to as 'too neutral' which often is referred to as India's stubbornness. However, India has never been a satellite state or a camp follower. India itself is a unique pole in the multipolar world, which refuses to be led by any other pole/alignment.

The classical view of polarity in the intl system, is of domination and alliance building on the basis of ideology. However, Indian view of polarity never strives to achieve domination which it could have achieved in the South Asian regional subsystem.

Though India believes in strategic periphery in South Asia where it has a natural claim to primacy.

To refer India as too neutral is an oversimplified claim as India always speaks for "underprivileged collectives".

For instance, India has clearly taken up the collective issues of Global South, island nations, developing world (WTO & UNFCCC).

Even India has clearly made decisive statements on relevant global issues. For eg - India categorically defeated the issue of bringing climate change at UNSC. Even in Russia-Ukraine war, India has affirmed in 2022 that "war is never acceptable".

According to S Jaishankar "Indian Way", India of 21st cen, has to distinguish between optimistic nonalignment

- the past from the realistic "multi engagements" of the future. In this direction, India's neutrality will uphold India's national interest.

For instance, 1) India is participating in Russia led Vostok military exercise, Aus's Pitch Black and USA's Yudh Abhyas. at the same time and is able to get the best of all the ~~res~~ sides.

11) Through such positive neutrality, India is also balancing SCO, BRICS, QUAD, IPEF, 1202 simultaneously and reaping dividends of economic cooperation.